

Teacher

1. Could you describe how you normally plan and submit your working availability for the month?

I look at my calendar for the upcoming month and fill in a shared spreadsheet with the days and times I can teach, up to five weeks ahead as the school asks. I try to get it in a few days before the 19th cut-off so I have a buffer in case something comes up.

2. In what ways do you communicate your preferences regarding lesson timings, student levels, or instruments to the management?

Mostly informally, a message or a note next to my availability on the spreadsheet. There isn't really a structured way to do it right now, which means preferences sometimes get missed when the manager is rushing through the roster.

3. When you choose a job preference for the week, what kind of preferences do you usually choose from? e.g. preferred days, back-to-back lessons

Mainly preferred days, whether I want back-to-back lessons or gaps in between, and sometimes a preferred studio if I'm used to a particular setup.

4. What info do you need to track your confirmed teaching schedule & monthly hrs?

My confirmed slots for the week, the running total of hours for the month so far, and how that compares to what I originally requested.

5. How far in advance do you typically know your teaching schedule and your own availability?

I know my own availability about five weeks out since that's how far ahead I can submit it. I usually don't get my confirmed schedule until a few days after the 20th though, once the manager's finished allocating for the week.

6. Before you commit your availability for next month, what do you need to know or see?

My own hours from the previous month, mainly, so I know if I should be asking for more or less. Beyond that it's really just my own personal calendar and commitments.

7. How do you currently check your weekly schedule and monthly workload?

I check the shared spreadsheet, or the manager sends it to me directly once it's published.

8. What happens if your availability changes unexpectedly after the 19th cut-off date?

I message the manager directly and explain. They'll try to accommodate it, but I know it's harder for them once the schedule's already being built, so I only do it when it's genuinely unavoidable.

9. Describe the process if you wanted to reject a job.

I let the manager know as early as possible, usually with a reason, and we talk it through. It's rarely a flat no, it's more a conversation about whether there's an alternative first.

10. What factors influence your decision to reject an assigned job, and how would you prefer to communicate this?

Mostly timing conflicts with my own schedule, or occasionally a student level I don't feel is a good fit. I'd prefer to do it through the app directly rather than a message, as long as it still prompts me to discuss it with the manager first, since that conversation still matters to me.

Current Workflow & Communication

11. Walk me through how you currently find out what your schedule is for next week and track your monthly hours.

The manager sends the published roster, and I keep my own running tally in a notes app, since the spreadsheet totals aren't always up to date the moment something changes.

12. When you need to change your availability after you've already submitted it, what do you do?

I message the manager. There's no way for me to edit the spreadsheet myself once it's already been used for planning, so it has to go through them.

Preferences & Usability

13. Do you prefer back-to-back lessons or gaps between them? Why?

Back-to-back, honestly, since it keeps my day tighter and I'm not sitting around the school between lessons. I still need the mandatory one-hour break after a 4-hour block though, that one I don't compromise on.

14. What device do you typically use to check your schedule — phone, laptop, tablet?

My phone, mostly. I'll use a laptop if I'm doing something more involved, like submitting a full month of availability.

15. How far in advance do you typically know about changes to your personal schedule (appointments, commitments)?

Usually a few days, sometimes a week if it's something planned. Last-minute things do happen occasionally though.

16. If the system sent you a notification when a new lesson was assigned, how would you prefer to receive it — email, text, app notification?

An app notification would be ideal, with email as a backup in case I miss it.

Job Rejection & Preferences

17. When you reject a job, what's the typical reason? Is it timing, student level, or something else?

Timing, almost always. Student level comes up occasionally too, but it's rare.

18. If you could see one piece of information about a potential assignment before it's confirmed, what would it be?

The student's level and how many lessons they've had before, so I know roughly what I'm walking into before I accept.

19. Do you have preferences about which students you teach? How do those preferences get communicated now?

A little, mostly around age group or beginner versus advanced. Right now that's communicated informally to the manager, it isn't tracked anywhere formal.

Non-Functional (Usability)

20. How often would you realistically check the system in a typical week?

A few times, probably once when the new week's schedule comes out and then a couple of quick checks during the week.

21. If the system was unavailable for a few hours during scheduling week, how would that affect you?

It would be frustrating but not disastrous, as long as it's back before the schedule needs to be finalised. I'd just want a heads up so I know to expect a delay.

22. How comfortable are you with using new software? Any concerns about learning a new system?

Reasonably comfortable. My main concern is just that it isn't more work than the spreadsheet, if it takes longer to log my availability than it does now, I probably won't keep up with it consistently.